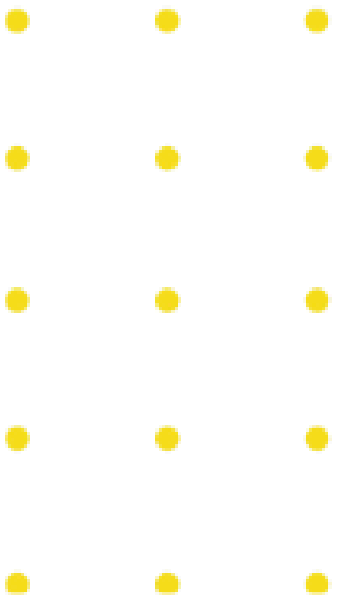
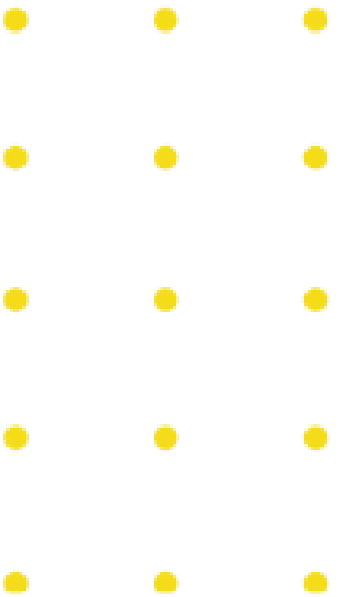


Module 5:

Networking Devices



Topic 1: Network Interface Card

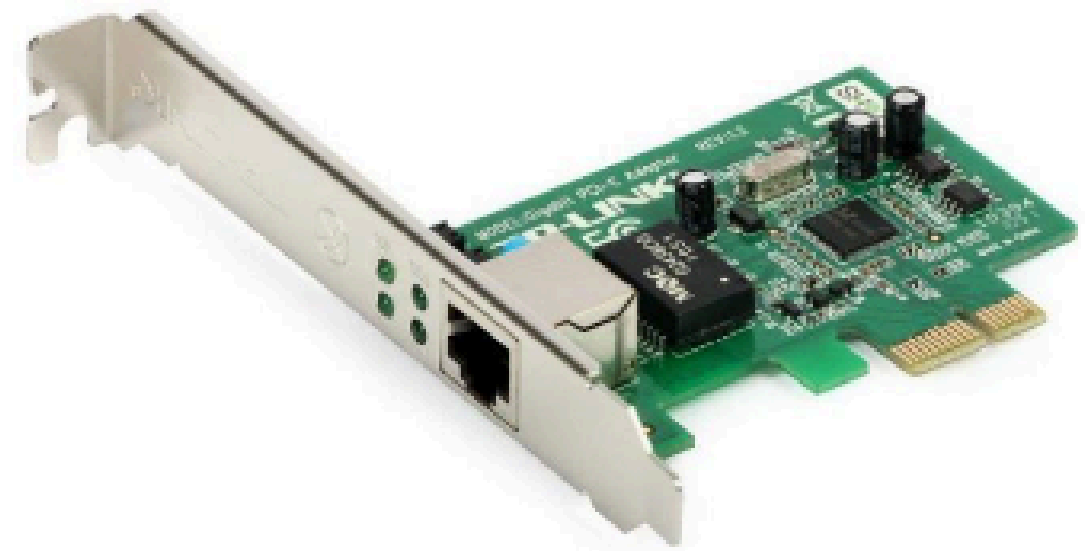


Network Interface Card

- A network interface card (NIC) is a hardware component without which a computer cannot be connected over a network.
- It is a circuit board installed in a computer that provides a dedicated network connection to the computer.
- It is also called network interface controller, network adapter or LAN adapter.

Network Interface Card Types

- **Internal:** In internal networks cards, motherboard has a slot for the network card where it can be inserted. It requires network cables to provide network access.
- **External:** In desktops and laptops that do not have an internal NIC, external NICs are used. External network cards are of two types: Wireless and USB based.



Network Interface Card Types

- **WNIC:** Wireless network Interface cards, are the network device that used to connect network devices to wireless networks.

Wireless network Interface cards can be in form of internal or external devices.



Why Network Interface Card?

Purpose

- NIC allows both wired and wireless communications.
- NIC allows communications between computers connected via local area network (LAN) as well as communications over large-scale network through Internet Protocol (IP)
- **Mac address:** It is a unique identifier assigned to **NIC** to be able to communicate through small segment of network.

